PORTLAND PUBLIC SCHOOLS

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STAFF REPORT

Date: May 13, 2025

To: School Board

From: Yian Saechao, Student Engagement Specialist
JJ Kunsevi, Student Representative to the Board

Subject: Proposed Amendments to the Student Representative and District Student Council Policy 1.20.012-P

BACKGROUND

The District Student Council is currently composed of one representative and one alternate representative from each high school. The Council has proposed a structural change to eliminate the alternate representative position and instead designate two representatives from each school. This proposal reflects the current engagement of alternate representatives, who already participate as full members of the Council.

Implementing this change would require revising the existing policy language, which currently states that each school's Student Body President serves as the alternate representative to the District Student Council.

Additionally, the District Student Council has recommended modifying the attendance threshold required to earn elective credit for participation. Specifically, the proposed change would lower the required attendance from 90% to 80% of meetings throughout the year. The Senior Director of High School Core Academics reviewed this recommendation and expressed no concerns, noting that high school elective credit is typically awarded based on the completion of assignments rather than specified attendance percentages.

A draft policy incorporating all three proposed amendments was presented at the Policy Committee meeting on May 12, 2025. Committee members recommended forwarding the amended policy to the full Board for approval.

RELATED POLICIES/BEST PRACTICES

It is best practice for the policies to align with current practices.

FISCAL IMPACT

There is no fiscal impact projected for these changes to the policy.

TIMELINE FOR IMPLEMENTATION / EVALUATION

The changes will be implemented immediately.

CONNECTION TO BOARD GOALS

These revisions reflect the Board's goal of amplifying student voice in District decisions.

STAFF RECOMMENDATION

Staff recommends that the Board adopt these revisions to the Student Representative and District Student Council Policy.

ATTACHMENTS

A. Redline version Student Representative and District Student Council Policy 1.20.012-P